

Word family: **casual / casually / casualness / casuals**

Base word: casual

Related forms: casually, casualness

Plural noun form: casuals

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun in some uses (名詞 , 部分用法)

Your sentence:

> “It has become my go-to jacket for **casual outings**, such as meeting friends, going to cafés, or even taking a walk in the evening.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **casual** means **informal and relaxed rather than formal, ceremonial, or dressy**.

A **casual outing** is an ordinary, relaxed social activity that does not require formal clothing or elaborate planning.

繁體中文： **休閒的；輕鬆非正式的；不是正式場合或正式打扮的**

中文翻譯：

> “...my go-to jacket for **casual outings**...”

「.....它已經成為我日常**休閒外出**時最常穿的外套.....」

Here:

casual outing = 輕鬆、非正式的外出活動，例如喝咖啡、見朋友、散步等

1. **casual = informal / relaxed in style or occasion (場合 / 衣著) — 休閒的；非正式的**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Relaxed and informal rather than formal, ceremonial, or highly arranged.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I usually wear the jacket on **casual** outings.”

「我通常在**休閒外出**時穿這件外套。」

Practice 2

> “The restaurant has a **casual** atmosphere.”

「這間餐廳的氣氛很**輕鬆休閒**。」

Practice 3

> “You can wear **casual** clothes to the event.”

「你可以穿**休閒服裝**出席活動。」

casual = 場合、服裝、風格或氣氛輕鬆，不要求正式規格

Common:

- * casual clothes
- * casual wear
- * casual restaurant
- * casual atmosphere
- * casual outing
- * casual meeting

2. **casual** = relaxed / not showing much concern or seriousness (態度) — 隨意的；漫不經心的；**輕鬆的**

Casual can describe someone’s manner, tone, attitude, or behaviour when they appear relaxed and not especially serious or concerned.

Practice 4

> “He gave a **casual** shrug.”

「他很**隨意地**聳了聳肩。」

Practice 5

> “She sounded surprisingly **casual** about the problem.”

「她談到這個問題時顯得出奇地**輕描淡寫** / 不太在意。」

casual = 態度輕鬆、不拘謹，有時甚至顯得沒有把事情看得很重要

This can be neutral or negative depending on context.

3. **casual = careless / not sufficiently careful (漫不經心) — 草率的 ; 不夠認真的**

A stronger negative extension of Meaning 2 is **casual = careless**.

Practice 6

> “A **casual** approach to safety can be dangerous.”

「對安全採取**草率 / 漫不經心**的態度可能很危險。」

Practice 7

> “The error resulted from **casual** handling of the data.”

「這個錯誤源於對資料處理得太過**隨便 / 草率**。」

casual = 因態度太隨意而缺乏應有的小心、認真或責任感

For strict counting, I would keep this under Meaning 2 as a negative extension.

4. **casual = occasional / not regular (頻率) — 偶爾的 ; 非固定的**

Casual can mean occurring only occasionally rather than regularly.

Practice 8

> “He is only a **casual** visitor to the museum.”

「他只是偶爾去博物館的**非固定訪客**。」

Practice 9

> “She is a **casual** reader rather than a serious collector.”

「她只是**偶爾閱讀的人**，並不是認真的收藏家。」

casual = 偶爾發生、並非固定或經常性的

Common:

* casual visitor

* casual user

- * casual reader
- * casual customer

This is a major distinct sense.

5. **casual = temporary / irregular employment (工作) — 臨時的 ; 非固定僱用的**

In employment, **casual** can describe work that is temporary, irregular, or without guaranteed fixed hours.

Practice 10

> “He found **casual** work during the summer.”

「他暑假期間找到了一些**臨時工作**。」

Practice 11

> “The café employs several **casual** workers.”

「這間咖啡店聘用了幾名**臨時 / 非固定工時員工**。」

****casual work = 沒有固定長期安排、工時或持續聘用保障的工作****

This is a well-established employment sense.

Depending on jurisdiction, **casual employee** can also have a precise legal meaning, so specific employment-law interpretation depends on location.

6. **casual = not committed / not serious in a relationship or activity (投入程度) — 隨意的 ; 非認真的**

****Casual**** can describe a relationship, interest, or involvement that is not intended to be serious, permanent, or highly committed.

Practice 12

> “They had only a **casual** friendship.”

「他們只是普通而不太深入的**泛泛之交**。」

Practice 13

> “He has a **casual** interest in photography.”

「他只是對攝影有一點**隨興 / 非深入的興趣**。」

casual = 沒有高度投入、承諾或深度的

Common:

* casual acquaintance

* casual friendship

* casual interest

* casual relationship

This is genuinely useful and distinct from merely “informal.”

7. **casual** = happening by chance / not planned (偶然) — 偶然的；碰巧的

Casual can describe an encounter, remark, observation, etc. that happens without deliberate planning.

Practice 14

> “A **casual** conversation led to the idea.”

「一次**偶然的 / 隨意的**談話帶出了這個想法。」

Practice 15

> “The discovery began with a **casual** observation.”

「這項發現源於一次**偶然的觀察**。」

casual = 不是刻意安排，而是順便、偶然或自然發生的

This is an established meaning, though somewhat less central than the informal/occasional senses.

8. **casual** = superficial / not detailed (查看 / 注意) — 粗略的；隨便看看的

A **casual glance**, **casual inspection**, or **casual observer** suggests limited attention or depth.

Practice 16

> “At a **casual** glance, the two pictures look identical.”

「乍看之下 / 粗略一看，兩張圖片看起來一模一樣。」

Practice 17

> “A **casual** observer might not notice the difference.”

「一個只是隨便看看的人可能不會注意到差別。」

casual = 沒有仔細、深入或系統地觀察 / 研究的

This is a major useful branch.

9. **casual** = incidental / secondary rather than central (次要 / 附帶) — 附帶的；偶然產生的

In more formal contexts, **casual** can describe something incidental rather than essential or deliberately intended.

Example:

> “The project brought some casual benefits.”

This type of use exists, but it is far less common in ordinary modern English.

For your database, I would keep it **lower priority** rather than make it a core learner meaning.

10. **casual** = noun, casual worker (名詞) — 臨時工

In some varieties of English, **a casual** can mean a casual/temporary worker.

Practice 18

> “The company hired extra **casuals** for the holiday period.”

「公司在假期期間額外聘請了一些臨時工。」

a casual = 臨時受僱、非固定工時的員工

This derives from the employment sense.

11. **casuals** = casual clothing (名詞複數) — 休閒服

In some contexts, especially retail/fashion language, **casuals** can refer to casual clothes.

Example:

> “The store sells both formalwear and casuals.”

「這間店同時售賣正式服裝和**休閒服**。」

This is valid but less common than simply:

> casual clothes

> casual wear

So it is lower priority.

Related form: **casually**

Casually has several branches corresponding to **casual**.

casually = informally (休閒地)

Practice 19

> “Everyone was dressed **casually**.”

「大家都穿得很**休閒**。」

casually = without much concern (隨意地)

Practice 20

> “He **casually** mentioned the problem.”

「他很**隨意地 / 輕描淡寫地**提到了這個問題。」

casually = by chance / without planning (偶然地)

> “They met casually through mutual friends.”

「他們透過共同朋友**偶然認識**。」

Context determines the branch.

Related form: **casualness**

Casualness means the quality of being casual.

Practice 21

> “Her **casualness** made the conversation feel comfortable.”

「她的**隨和 / 輕鬆態度**令談話感覺很自在。」

Practice 22

> “The **casualness** of his response worried me.”

「他回答得如此**漫不經心**，令我有點擔心。」

The same noun can therefore sound positive or negative.

Useful compound: **business casual**

Business casual means a style of workplace clothing that is less formal than a suit but still neat and professionally appropriate.

Practice 23

> “The office dress code is **business casual**.”

「辦公室的衣着要求是**商務休閒**。」

This is a lexicalized clothing compound under Meaning 1.

Important distinction: **casual vs informal**

informal

means not formal.

casual

often adds:

- * relaxed
- * everyday
- * unceremonious

> informal language

> casual clothes

There is strong overlap, but **casual** often feels more relaxed and everyday.

Important distinction: **casual vs relaxed**

relaxed

focuses on lack of tension or pressure.

casual

can refer to:

- * informality
- * lack of commitment
- * occasional frequency
- * superficial attention

So **casual** is much broader.

Important distinction: **casual vs careless**

casual

can simply mean relaxed and informal.

careless

means failing to take enough care.

Compare:

- > casual conversation
- > careless mistake

A casual attitude becomes negative only when the situation requires more seriousness.

Important distinction: ****casual vs occasional****

****occasional****

simply means happening from time to time.

****casual****

can describe a person whose involvement is occasional and not committed.

- > occasional visitor
- > casual visitor

They overlap strongly in that branch.

Important distinction: ****casual vs temporary****

For employment:

****temporary****

emphasizes that the job lasts for a limited period.

****casual****

often emphasizes:

- * irregular hours
- * no fixed ongoing schedule
- * work offered as needed

A temporary job can have fixed full-time hours; casual employment may not.

Important distinction: **casual vs random**

random

means selected or happening without a clear pattern or method.

casual

in the chance sense means unplanned or incidental.

> random selection

> casual encounter

Not interchangeable in many contexts.

Important distinction: **casual vs superficial**

superficial

means lacking depth.

casual

can imply lack of detailed attention:

> casual glance

> casual inspection

But **superficial** is generally more explicitly critical.

Grammar note: **casual** is highly collocational

The exact Traditional Chinese translation changes strongly with the noun:

* casual clothes → 休閒服

* casual outing → 輕鬆 / 休閒外出

* casual worker → 臨時工

* casual remark → 隨口說的話

* casual glance → 粗略一看

* casual visitor → 偶爾到訪的人

* casual relationship → 非認真 / 非承諾性的關係

These should ****not**** automatically become separate English meanings merely because Chinese requires different wording. The underlying semantic concept decides the split.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****casual****
* ****casually****
* ****casualness****
* ****casuals****

Important constructions/compounds:

* casual clothes
* casual outing
* casual conversation
* casual visitor
* casual worker
* casual glance
* casual acquaintance
* business casual

The word's semantic network revolves around ****lack of formality, regularity, commitment, planning, or detailed attention****, but those dimensions separate enough in modern English to justify several learner-facing branches.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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casual — informal/style	輕鬆、休閒、非正式的；不要求正式場合或正式打扮
casual — manner/attitude	態度隨意、不拘謹，有時顯得不太認真或不在意
casual — occasional	偶爾參與、並非固定或經常性的
casual — employment	工時 / 聘用安排非固定、按需要工作的臨時性工作
casual — commitment	關係、興趣或參與程度不深入、不長期承諾的
casual — chance/unplanned	沒有刻意安排、偶然或順便發生的
casual — superficial attention	沒有仔細或深入觀察、只是粗略看看的
a casual	臨時工；部分語境下的名詞用法
casually	休閒地；隨意地；漫不經心地；偶然地
casualness	輕鬆隨意或漫不經心的性質
business casual	商務休閒服裝風格

For your original sentence

> “It has become my go-to jacket for **casual outings**...”

The exact meaning is:

casual = 輕鬆、日常、不正式，不需要特別打扮的

So:

> **casual outings**

= 日常休閒外出 / 輕鬆非正式的外出活動

For your database, I would count **6 genuinely useful core meanings** for **casual**:

1. **informal / relaxed in dress, style, or occasion**
2. **relaxed or insufficiently serious in manner/attitude**
3. **occasional / not regular**
4. **temporary or irregular employment**
5. **not deeply committed / not serious**
6. **unplanned or superficial — casual encounter / casual glance**

For #6, I would keep **chance/unplanned** and **superficial-attention** visibly distinguished in examples, but they can be merged at a high-level database structure if you want a more conservative core count.